

COVID-19 death toll in Mass. increases to 48

► WALSH

Continued from Page B1

buildings into shelters for homeless people as part of a plan to make about 550 new beds available. The announcement followed Boston's first case of COVID-19 among the city's homeless population, the mayor said.

The new sites, which include 172 beds at Suffolk University's Nathan R. Miller Hall dormitory and 70 beds at the shuttered Kindred Hospital Boston in Brighton, are intended to ease the burden on existing shelters and slow the spread of the fast-moving virus.

Walsh said the city hopes that by adding resources for homeless people, it can ease the burden on health care facilities where they might otherwise wind up if they become sick on the streets or in overcrowded shelters.

The public health system is already being pushed to its limits by the crisis, with some skilled nursing facilities being converted into coronavirus treatment centers to relieve pressure on nearby hospitals.

"We're looking at how do we find and help as many populations as possible so we're not overwhelming our medical facilities and only the most serious cases go there," Walsh said. He added there could be more sites coming into use soon.



PAT GREENHOUSE/GLOBE STAFF

Mayor Martin J. Walsh gave an update on the coronavirus crisis outside of Boston City Hall on Sunday.

cvd_465

Clipped By:
relianceenwerem
Mar 30, 2026